

# 44 Tenses in reported speech

In reported speech, the reported verb usually “goes back” a tense. Time and place references and pronouns sometimes also change.

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Present continuous 4 Past continuous 10

Past perfect simple 13 Modal verbs 56

## 44.1 REPORTED SPEECH IN DIFFERENT TENSES

The tense used in reported speech is usually one tense back in time from the tense in direct speech.

**I'm working** in New York.



She said **she was working** in New York.

PRESENT CONTINUOUS



PAST CONTINUOUS

**I've been** to China twice.



He said that **he'd been** to China twice.

PRESENT PERFECT



PAST PERFECT

**I will call** you soon.



He said **he would call** them soon.

FUTURE WITH "WILL"



MODAL VERB "WOULD"

**We can speak** Japanese.



They said that **they could speak** Japanese.

MODAL VERB "CAN"



MODAL VERB "COULD"